slip for eight. The crowd gave him a standing ovation, which seemed to get louder and louder. The electronic scoreboard read simply 'Thanks Ricky' and each of us, his opponents, made a point of running across to shake his hand. To coin a phrase, he was a great batsman as great batsmen go and, as great batsmen go, he went … with dignity and respect from all sides.

Australia fought hard, as you would expect, and Mitchell Starc thrashed an unbeaten 68 towards the end, but we eventually bowled them out for 322, won the Test by 309 runs, and won the series 1–0.

'It takes a team effort to win away from home,' Graeme said afterwards. 'Everybody is contributing and pulling their weight. That's the outstanding thing about our team. What we've been able to achieve, it will take a long time for people to understand. To have won a Test series in both England and in Australia in 2008 was special, but to repeat the same feat four years later is the proudest achievement of my career.'

Graeme had led. We had followed. The record shows that, in the space of six years from 2006, we had played 10 Test series away from home, winning eight and drawing two … unbeaten. That is the legacy of a great team, but I know it simply would not have happened without the leadership of a great captain.

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My workload had become demanding to say the least, batting in all three formats, keeping wicket in all three formats and captaining the Proteas in both ODI and T20 cricket. Coach Gary Kirsten recognised the situation, and I supported his decision to appoint Faf du Plessis as captain of the T20 side.

Continuity may have been lost but the burden was reasonably shared, with Graeme continuing to lead the Test team, me captaining the ODI side and Faf leading the team in T20 internationals.